



T-Series sues Roposo

T-Series filed a lawsuit against short-video platform, Roposo, on the grounds of copyright infringement. <http://digit.in/sep20-19>



Microscopic Robots

Researchers have developed a microscopic robot capable of being controlled by lasers. <http://digit.in/sep20-20>

Sony WF-1000XM3

The best noise-cancelling truly wireless earbuds out there

The crown jewel of Sony's true wireless lineup, the Sony WF-1000XM3 Noise Cancelling headphones, has finally made its way to the Indian wireless headphones market. How do these earphones fare in the real world? Let's find out in our review.

Build and design

The Sony WF-1000XM3 exudes an air of sophistication and class. The dual-tone, copper and black finish is certainly eye-catching. The charging case is not what we'd term as pocketable though. The earbuds feature an elongated rounded design on the back, resembling a pill, while the top tapers into the angled earphone nozzle. The back panel on each pill-shaped earbud houses the Sony logo, and a circular touch control panel. The earbuds are quite sizable and do stick out of the ears considerably. The touch controls are accessible via both earbuds and are quite intuitive. The earphones also come equipped with features such as a nifty Awareness Mode and auto play/pause.

In terms of comfort, the Sony WF-1000XM3 works wonders for most ear shapes and sizes. The earbuds need to be twisted into place and are secured by the very structure of your ear with Sony's Tri Hold design. Sony has also provided a vast array of silicone and foam earbud tips. Nevertheless, as secure as the fit is, we'd advise against using these buds in the gym or in rainy conditions since they lack an IP rating.

App support

Sony has one of the most versatile apps for their Bluetooth audio devices – Sony | Headphones Connect. The app houses a plethora of features and customisation options such as a fully customisable EQ, sound presets, Adaptive Sound Control (both location and action-based), Ambient Sound controls,



customisable touch controls, and 360 Reality Audio.

ANC and Ambient Sound

The two headlining features of the earphones are Noise Cancellation and Ambient Sound. Noise Cancellation on the Sony WF-1000XM3 is exceptional for in-ears. We tried out the ANC with various environmental sounds such as AC drone, rainy conditions, full-speed fans, traffic and horns of vehicles, and even people talking in the background. The QN1 engine shows its prowess and the earphones are able to suppress almost every sound and completely silence low-frequency, constant sounds. When it comes to Ambient Sound, the external sounds are enhanced but the effect is artificial and could be jarring to some. To combat this, you can reduce the Ambient Sound levels via the app.

Performance

Sony is known for its bass-forward audio headsets, however, on these true wireless headphones, the company has gone for a vibrant, yet balanced sound profile that is not bass dominated. In bass-heavy hip-hop or EDM tracks, the punchiness of the bass is undeniable, yet it is controlled. Tracks such as *Billie Eilish's bad guy* sound sublime. Vocals and mid-ranged instruments sound rich and detailed. The treble frequencies also have been extended minutely which affects how instruments such as tambourines and cymbals sound in

conjunction with vocals and lows. In *Hysteria* by Muse, the cymbals are clear despite there being a number of instruments and strong vocals in the mix.

Now, coming to the microphone, the Sony WF-1000XM3 does a pretty good job in calls. The voices are relayed quite well and the speaker's voice doesn't sound too muffled or distant.

Battery life

The battery life of the Sony WF-1000XM3 is also pretty good. With ANC turned on, the company claims about 6 hours of playback on a single charge and with ANC off, the numbers are bumped up to 8 hours. The charging case stores 3 additional charges. It also comes with Quick Charging where a 10-minute charge provides over an hour of playback. In our tests, with mixed usage of ANC, Ambient Mode and Ambient mode off, the earphones lasted about 6.5 hours, which is pretty decent.

Bottomline

There's not much to criticise with the Sony WF-1000XM3 since you get solid sound quality, exceptional ANC, long battery life and a host of premium features. The only features we sorely missed were wireless charging for the case, an IP rating and aptX support. Sony has also priced these pretty competitively at ₹19,990. However, if you want something more fitness-oriented, you need to go another route.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

HEADPHONE TYPE: Closed, dynamic | DRIVER UNIT SIZE: 6mm | DSEE HX: Yes | FREQUENCY RESPONSE (BLUETOOTH): 20Hz - 20kHz | BATTERY LIFE (CONTINUOUS MUSIC PLAYBACK TIME): Max. 6 hours (NC on) / Max. 8 hours (NC off) | EARPHONE BATTERY CHARGE TIME: 1.5 hours | CHARGING CASE BATTERY CHARGE TIME: 3.5 hours | BLUETOOTH VERSION: Bluetooth v5.0 | EFFECTIVE RANGE: 33 feet / 10m | SUPPORTED AUDIO FORMATS: SBC, AAC | NOISE-CANCELLING: Yes | NFC: Yes | APPROX. WEIGHT: 77g

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